

Using LAD

A guide for learners, trainers, and administrators — what each screen is for, how to finish the tasks you came to do, and why you see the records you see.

3

PORTALS

62

DESTINATIONS

4

SCOPE LEVELS

What this covers

1. Getting started — signing in and finding your way
2. What you can see — the four scope levels
3. For learners — attendance, marks, subjects, portfolio
4. For trainers — attendance, enrolment, marks, reports
5. For administrators — people, structure, oversight
6. Reports and exports — every report, and how to get it out
7. Troubleshooting — "why can't I see it?"
8. Navigation reference — every menu entry, per portal
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READ THIS FIRST

Two different things decide what appears on your screen. Your **role** decides which menu entries exist for you at all; your **scope** decides whose records those screens then show. A screen that opens but looks empty is almost always the second one — see section 2, and Troubleshooting.

This guide describes what to do in the interface. Its companion, **Working With Permissions**, describes how access is granted in the first place, and is written for whoever administers roles.

Getting started

Signing in

- 1 Open LAD and sign in with your email address and password on the **Welcome Back** screen. Accounts are created for you — there is no public self-registration.
- 2 You land on the dashboard for your account type. There is no portal to choose: LAD reads it from your account and sends you to the right one.
- 3 If a permission changes while you are signed in, sign out and back in. Permissions are read once, at sign-in.

The three portals

Learner

Your own record: marks, subjects, attendance, exams, portfolio evidence, and feedback on your trainers.

Lands on `/student/dashboard`

Trainer

The subjects assigned to you and the learners on them — attendance, marks, assessments, and class analytics.

Lands on `/trainer-hub`

Staff / Administrator

People, academic structure, and oversight across whatever part of the organisation you are responsible for.

Lands on `/admin/dashboard`

A staff account with neither a learner nor a trainer profile is treated as the third kind. If such a role has not been granted the admin dashboard, it lands on **Reports** instead, so there is always somewhere to arrive.

Finding your way

- The **sidebar** is grouped by job — Overview, People, Academics, Reports, Attendance. Click a group heading to collapse it, and the arrows at the top to narrow the whole sidebar to icons.
- The sidebar only lists what you may open. If an entry is not there, your role has not been granted it — it is not hidden behind a menu somewhere else.
- Screens that build up over several stages label them **Step 1**, **Step 2**, and so on, top to bottom. Work down the page.
- Tables share one set of controls: click a column heading to sort, use the search box to narrow, and page through at the bottom.

What you can see

Every list, report, and dashboard in LAD is filtered to you before it is fetched. Four levels exist, narrowest first. You sit at exactly one.

Trainer	The subjects assigned to you, and the learners, marks, attendance, and documents that belong to them.
Head of department	Every course, trainer, and cohort in your department — across all the trainers in it.
College administrator	Everything belonging to your college. Not the other colleges, even with a full administrative role.
Group super admin	Every college. This is the only level that reads across the whole group.

A learner is narrower still: they see themselves, and nothing else, on every screen.

WHY AN ADMINISTRATOR DOES NOT SEE EVERY COLLEGE

What separates a college administrator from the group super admin is the **institution recorded on their account**, not the strength of their role. An account attached to a college is held to that college; the group account is attached to none, which is what lets it read them all. Cross-college oversight for anyone else is granted deliberately, as a single visible setting, and never arrives as a side effect of some other permission.

Reports that are narrowed say so. The **Enrolment & Attendance Overview** and the **Attendance Overview** both print the scope they are showing — "Your assigned subjects only", your department, or your college — so an unexpectedly short report reads as your scope rather than as missing data.

EMPTY IS NOT THE SAME AS BROKEN

A newly created trainer sees nothing at all until subjects are assigned to them. Their permissions may be complete and the screens will still be empty, because a trainer's data comes from their assignments. Ask an administrator to assign your units.

For learners

Check in to class

Attendance → **Check In**. Your trainer displays a QR code that changes every few seconds.

- 1 Open **Check In**. Allow location access when your browser asks — LAD requests it while you are still lining up the code, because the code expires faster than a location fix usually arrives.
- 2 Point your camera at the QR code. No camera? Choose *Enter code manually* and type the six-character session code your trainer reads out.
- 3 Confirm the check-in. Your position is compared with your trainer's, and you must be inside the radius they set for the session.

IF THE CHECK-IN IS REFUSED

GPS failed means you were outside the allowed radius, or your location was too imprecise to tell — move nearer a window and try again. *Not enrolled* means you are not on that subject's roster. *Duplicate* means you are already marked present. Your trainer can record you manually in any of these cases.

See your marks

Academics → **My Scores** lists every recorded mark with its assessment, grade, and whether it passed.

Reports → **Report Card** assembles the same marks into a printable termly card, and **Reports** → **Practical Reports** shows competency outcomes with the full task breakdown.

A mark is a percentage of the assessment it belongs to, so a paper out of 40 and one out of 100 are directly comparable. The pass threshold is **50%**.

Your subjects, documents, and portfolio

- **My Subjects** — what you are enrolled on, with your average in each.
- **Documents** — material your trainers have shared for those subjects.
- **My Portfolio** — upload evidence against the competencies your course requires, and track what is still outstanding.
- **Online Exams** — exams your trainer has published, sat in the browser.

Attendance and standing

Reports → **Attendance** shows your present, absent, and late records for the period. Sustained attendance below **75%**, or an average below **50%**, raises an alert to you and to the trainers who teach you; it clears itself when the figures recover. **Disciplinary Records** lists anything formally recorded against you.

Feedback, both directions

Trainer Feedback is feedback written to you. **Rate My Trainers** is where you submit yours.

Confirming what was taught

Academics → **Course Coverage** lists the topics your trainers have recorded as taught, and asks you to mark each one **Covered** or **Not covered**. Coverage is entered by the trainer who taught it, so without this there is nothing in the system that can tell a finished syllabus from a reported one.

YOUR ANSWERS ARE COUNTED, NOT ATTRIBUTED

Your department sees the class total against each topic — how much of the syllabus the group recognises — beside what the trainer reported. It does not see a per-topic list with your name against it.

For trainers

Your dashboard

The **Teaching Performance Hub** opens on all your assigned subjects. The **Assigned subject scope** selector at the top narrows every metric, chart, and panel below it to one subject — class average, mastery, attendance signal, at-risk learners, the competency heatmap, and the cohort comparison all follow it.

Take attendance

Attendance → **Take Attendance** runs a live QR session.

- 1 **Start Attendance Session**, and pick the class. Allow location access — your position is the centre of the check-in radius.
- 2 Set the **duration** (5 minutes is the recommended scan window), the **allowed radius** in metres, and how often the code refreshes.
- 3 Display the QR code. It regenerates on the interval you chose, so a screenshot passed to an absent learner expires almost immediately. The six-character session code beneath it is the fallback for anyone without a camera.
- 4 Watch check-ins arrive live, then end the session.

Attendance → **Manual Attendance** covers everyone the QR flow missed: select the class, then mark the register by hand.

Enrol learners onto a subject

People → **Learner Enrollment**. Choose one of your assigned subjects, then either enter a single learner's registration number or email, or import a roster. **Template** downloads a CSV with the columns the importer expects — `registration_number` and/or `email`. The import reports how many were enrolled, how many were already on the subject, and how many could not be found.

ENROLMENT ATTACHES, IT DOES NOT CREATE

This screen puts existing learners onto your subject. A learner who has never been added to the institution has to be created first, on the Students screen — which is also where a whole roster is imported.

Record marks

For a handful of marks, use the score form on your dashboard. For a whole class, use **Academics** → **Bulk Upload Marks**, which works down the page in four steps.

- 1 **Select Assessment**. Pick the assessment the marks belong to, then **Download Class List** — an Excel file already filled in with your learners and the codes the importer needs. Its assessment code is shown with a *Copy Code* button.

- 2 **Select Subject** (optional). Sets the subject for every row that does not name its own. Applies to the whole batch.
- 3 **Upload Marks File**. Fill in the marks column of the downloaded class list and upload it. You may also attach scans or photographs of the original scripts as evidence. Then **Preview & Validate**.
- 4 **Review & Commit**. The preview flags every invalid row, every learner who already has a mark for this assessment, and every learner the commit would attach to the subject. Nothing is written until you commit.

ALWAYS START FROM THE DOWNLOADED CLASS LIST

It carries the learner, assessment, module, and subject codes already filled in, so the only column you touch is the mark. A hand-built spreadsheet is where mismatched codes come from.

Assessments marked from three CATs have their own layout: choose the scenario and the class list carries a column per CAT, with the final mark computed for you.

Review and edit recorded marks

Academics → **Score Management** lists every mark in your scope. Filter to **one subject** with the subject dropdown, search by learner, course, subject, or assessment, and sort any column. Marks can be edited or removed here, and the filtered set exported to Excel, PDF, or CSV.

Track progress

Academics → **Progress** gives one row per learner with average, pass rate, assessment count, trend, and standing. The **subject filter** re-averages every learner over that subject alone rather than merely hiding rows, so the summary cards above the table describe the subject you picked. *Needs attention first* puts the weakest learners at the top.

Assessments and material

- **Practical Assess.** — author practical assessments and record competency outcomes against them.
- **Online Exams** — build an exam, publish it, and review submissions.
- **Documents** — share material with the learners on your subjects.
- **Competencies** — the competency framework your assessments evidence.

Your reports

- **Class Performance** — averages, pass rates, ranking, grade distribution.
- **Syllabus Coverage** — planned against covered topics.
- **Coverage Validation** — what you reported as covered, next to the coverage your learners confirm. Coverage is self-entered, so this is the second opinion; a persistent gap is what a head of department is shown.
- **Learner Attendance** — the attendance record for your classes.
- **Trainer Reports** — the exportable set of the above.

Feedback

Student Reports writes to a learner — the at-risk panel on your dashboard links straight into it with the learner and subject already selected. **My Feedback** is what learners have submitted about you.

For administrators

People

- 1 **People** → **Users** creates the account: name, email, **role**, and **institution**. The institution is what places the person in a college — without it they are not confined to one.
- 2 **People** → **Trainers** then assigns teaching. Use **Assign Subjects** to pick course, module, and subjects. A trainer sees nothing until this is done.
- 3 **People** → **Students** manages learner records and the course each is enrolled on.
- 4 **People** → **Roles** defines what each role may open. It is covered in full by the companion permissions guide.
- 5 Bulk import lives on the screen it belongs to: the **Students** and **Trainers** screens each carry an import panel that reports conflicts before anything is written.

Academic structure

The hierarchy runs **Institution → Department → Course → Module → Subject**, and each level has its own screen under **Institution**. Scope is resolved by walking this chain, so a course left without a department, or a module without a course, will drop cohorts out of reports. **Terms** defines the academic periods that reports group by; exactly one is active, and reports default to it.

Marks and oversight

- **Score Management** — every mark in your scope, filterable by subject, editable, exportable.
- **Bulk Upload Marks** — the same four-step flow trainers use.
- **Progress** — learner-by-learner standing across your scope.
- **Attendance Report** — sessions, check-in outcomes, and trainer activity for the trainers you oversee.
- **Compliance** — the audit view of what has and has not been recorded.

Dashboard and analytics

Admin Dashboard is the headline view — enrolment, pass rates, term trend, department performance.

Analytics is the same picture with the filters and breakdowns to interrogate it: by department, course, module, subject, trainer, or learner.

TAKING ACCESS AWAY

Removing a permission changes it for everyone holding that role. To narrow one person, move them to a narrower role instead. To stop a trainer seeing a class without touching their permissions at all, remove the subject assignment — that is what their visibility is built from.

Reports and exports

Report	Who	What it answers
Exam Results	Staff	Score average, average pass rate, and top course for the term, broken down by course and by subject, with movement against the previous term.
Exam Analysis	Staff	The same marks either aggregated by assessment, subject, and course, or listed as individual learner entries.
Enrolment & Attendance	Staff	Course population and attendance health, flagging any course below the 75% threshold.
Attendance Overview	Staff	Sessions, check-in outcomes, daily trend, and trainer activity.
Practical Assessments	Staff, learner	Competency outcomes in summary, or learner records with the full task breakdown.
Class Performance	Trainer	Averages, pass rates, ranking, and grade distribution for one class.
Syllabus Coverage	Trainer	Planned against covered topics, as a completion percentage.
Report Card	Learner	The termly record, ready to print.
My Attendance	Learner	Present, absent, and late records for the period.
Compliance	Staff	What has and has not been recorded, for audit.

Reports → **All Reports** is the catalogue of everything you can open, filtered to your role.

Getting a report out

- **Print** uses a print stylesheet — filter controls drop away and the header becomes a titled, dated document.
- **Excel** writes one sheet per breakdown.
- **PDF** writes the same tables as a document.
- **CSV** writes the main table only, for loading elsewhere.

EXPORTS FOLLOW YOUR FILTERS

Every export carries the rows currently on screen, not the unfiltered set, and records who generated it and when. Set the filters first, then export.

Troubleshooting

What you are seeing	What it means
A menu entry is missing	Your role has not been granted it. The sidebar, the address, and the underlying data all unlock together, so there is no other route to it.
"You do not have permission to view this"	You reached a screen your role cannot open. Ask an administrator for the key that screen needs.
The screen opens but is empty	The common case, and it is scope rather than permission. If you are a trainer, check your subject assignments; otherwise check the institution on your account.
A trainer sees no learners or marks	No units are assigned to them. Trainers → Assign Subjects. Permissions are not the problem.
A report shows less than expected	Check the scope label printed on it, and the term. Reports default to the active term, and marks filed under a different term will not appear.
A permission change had no effect	Permissions load at sign-in. Sign out and back in.
Check-in refused — GPS failed	You were outside the session's radius, or your position was too imprecise. Move nearer a window; the trainer can mark you manually.
A bulk upload row is rejected	The preview names the reason per row. Almost always a code that does not match — start again from the downloaded class list rather than a hand-built sheet.
Marks uploaded but missing from a report	They are probably filed under another term, or the learners are not attached to a course, so they cannot be grouped into a class. The Exam Results report says which.

A DIAGNOSTIC ORDER THAT WORKS

Ask in this order: **(1)** Is the entry in my sidebar? **(2)** If it opens but is empty, whose records should it show — am I in scope? **(3)** If I am a trainer, do I hold the unit? **(4)** Is the report on the right term? Nearly every question resolves at one of those four.

Navigation reference

Every entry in each portal's sidebar, in the order it appears. An entry is shown only when the role holds the key beside it — entries with no key are always shown to that portal. Several destinations appear in more than one portal; it is the same screen, scoped to whoever opened it.

Learner portal 17 entries

Menu entry	Address	Shown when the role holds
OVERVIEW		
Dashboard	<code>/student/dashboard</code>	Always shown
Notifications	<code>/student/notifications</code>	Always shown
Trainer Feedback	<code>/student/feedback</code>	Always shown
Rate My Trainers	<code>/student/rate-trainers</code>	Always shown
My Profile	<code>/student/profile</code>	Always shown
ACADEMICS		
My Scores	<code>/student/scores</code>	Always shown
My Subjects	<code>/student/subjects</code>	Always shown
Online Exams	<code>/student/online-exams</code>	Always shown
Documents	<code>/student/documents</code>	Always shown
My Portfolio	<code>/student/portfolio</code>	Always shown
Course Coverage	<code>/student/course-coverage</code>	Always shown
REPORTS		
All Reports	<code>/reports</code>	<code>reports.*</code>
Report Card	<code>/student/report-card</code>	<code>reports.student.term</code>
Practical Reports	<code>/student/practical-assessments</code>	Always shown
Attendance	<code>/student/attendance-report</code>	<code>reports.student.attendance</code>
Disciplinary Records	<code>/student/disciplinary-records</code>	Always shown
ATTENDANCE		
Check In	<code>/student/attendance/checkin</code>	Always shown

Trainer portal 34 entries

Menu entry	Address	Shown when the role holds
OVERVIEW		
Dashboard	/trainer-hub	Always shown
Analytics	/admin/analytics	admin.analytics.read
Notifications	/admin/notifications	notifications.read
PEOPLE		
Students	/students	students.read
Student Reports	/student-reports	reports.student.write
My Feedback	/trainer/feedback-received	Always shown
Users	/users	users.read
Student Profile	/trainer/student-profile	Always shown
Learner Enrollment	/trainer/enrollment	Always shown
ACADEMICS		
My Modules	/modules	modules.read
My Subjects	/subjects	subjects.read
Competencies	/competencies	competencies.read
Terms	/terms	terms.read
Score Management	/admin/scores	admin.scores.read
Bulk Upload Marks	/scores/bulk-upload	scores.create
Practical Assess.	/trainer/practical-assessments	Always shown
Online Exams	/trainer/online-exams	Always shown
Documents	/trainer/documents	Always shown
Progress	/progress	scores.read
REPORTS		
Exam Results	/admin/reports/exam-results	reports.admin.pass_rate
Exam Analysis	/reports/assessments/exams	reports.admin.pass_rate
Practical Reports	/reports/assessments/practical	reports.practical.assessment
Enrolment	/admin/reports/enrolment	reports.admin.enrolment

Menu entry	Address	Shown when the role holds
Disciplinary Records	/disciplinary-records	reports.student.discipline
All Reports	/reports	reports.*
Compliance	/admin/compliance	reports.admin.compliance
Trainer Reports	/trainer/reports	reports.class.performance
Class Performance	/trainer/class-performance	reports.class.performance
Syllabus Coverage	/trainer/syllabus	reports.teacher.syllabus
Coverage Validation	/reports/course-coverage	reports.teacher.syllabus
Learner Attendance	/trainer/attendance	reports.teacher.attendance
ATTENDANCE		
Take Attendance	/trainer/attendance-session	Always shown
Manual Attendance	/trainer/attendance/manual	Always shown
Attendance Report	/admin/attendance	attendance.report.view

Staff & administrator portal 33 entries

Menu entry	Address	Shown when the role holds
OVERVIEW		
Dashboard	/admin/dashboard	admin.analytics.read
Analytics	/admin/analytics	admin.analytics.read
Notifications	/admin/notifications	notifications.read
PEOPLE		
Students	/students	students.read
Trainers	/trainers	trainers.read
Student Reports	/admin/student-reports	reports.student.write
Trainer Feedback	/trainer/feedback-received	feedback.trainer.view
Users	/users	users.read
Roles	/roles	roles.read
INSTITUTION		
Institutions	/institutions	institutions.read

Menu entry	Address	Shown when the role holds
Departments	/departments	departments.read
Courses	/courses	courses.read
Modules	/modules	modules.read
Subjects	/subjects	subjects.read
Competencies	/competencies	competencies.read
Terms	/terms	terms.read
ACADEMICS		
Score Management	/admin/scores	admin.scores.read
Bulk Upload Marks	/admin/scores/bulk-upload	scores.create
Practical Assess.	/admin/practical-assessments	practical.assessments.manage
Online Exams	/admin/online-exams	online_exams.manage
Documents	/admin/documents	documents.read
Progress	/progress	scores.read
REPORTS		
Exam Results	/admin/reports/exam-results	reports.admin.pass_rate
Exam Analysis	/reports/assessments/exams	reports.admin.pass_rate
Practical Reports	/reports/assessments/practical	reports.practical.assessment
Enrolment	/admin/reports/enrolment	reports.admin.enrolment
Disciplinary Records	/disciplinary-records	reports.student.discipline
All Reports	/reports	reports.*
Course Coverage	/reports/course-coverage	reports.teacher.syllabus
Compliance	/admin/compliance	reports.admin.compliance
ATTENDANCE		
Take Attendance	/trainer/attendance-session	attendance.create
Manual Attendance	/admin/attendance/manual	attendance.create
Attendance Report	/admin/attendance	attendance.report.view

Glossary

Term	Meaning in LAD
Institution	A college. The top of the academic hierarchy, and the boundary most staff are held to.
Department	A division of a college, owning courses and trainers. The boundary a head of department is held to.
Course	The programme a learner is enrolled on, at a CBET level.
Module	A block of a course, containing subjects.
Subject	The unit actually taught. Trainers are assigned subjects, and it is the assignment that decides what they see.
Assessment	A specific piece of marked work, with a total and a pass mark. Marks belong to assessments.
CAT	Continuous assessment test. Three of them can be combined into one final mark by a chosen formula.
Competency	A skill a learner must evidence. Practical assessments and portfolio evidence are recorded against these.
Term	The academic period reports group by. One is active at a time, and reports default to it.
Scope	Whose records a screen shows you, decided separately from whether you may open it.
Session	One live attendance sitting, with a rotating QR code, a time limit, and a radius.
At risk	A learner averaging below 50%, or attending below 75% over the last 90 days.

Rebuilding this document

```
python3 docs/build_user_guide.py
```

The navigation reference is parsed from the dashboard's sidebar, so a destination added there appears here on the next rebuild without being retyped.